Reading and writing

2026-11-09 | Week 5 | Small actions help

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.9D(i)

3.9D(i): Recognize characteristics and structures of informational text, including: the central idea with supporting evidence. In plain English: Identify an informational text's central idea and the details that support it. Today: Use one page detail to explain what the book teaches.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.9D(i), 4.7C

4.9D(i): Recognize characteristics and structures of informational text, including: the central idea with supporting evidence. In plain English: Identify an informational text's central idea and the details that support it. 4.7C: Use text evidence to support an appropriate response. In plain English: Support an answer with something the text actually says or shows. Today: Compare two details and explain how they support the central idea.

I Do

Book connection: Sort facts, illustrations and text features into a central idea with supporting details. Read a short, accessible scene from The Pumpkin Book. Show a visual sequence strip: beginning, middle, end. Ask the shared WH question, "Who is here, where are they, and what happens first?" Model pointing to a picture, choosing an answer card, using AAC or dictating a sentence. Then connect the same scene to each learner's target: Grade 3 use one page detail to explain what the book teaches.; Grade 4 compare two details and explain how they support the central idea..

We Do

Return to The Pumpkin Book and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Reread the same scene aloud. Both learners use the same book, illustrations and three-part sequence mat. Ask who, what, where, when, why and how questions about the beginning, middle and end. Grade 3 arranges picture cards and answers with pointing, speech, AAC or dictation. Grade 4 explains the event, character action or evidence using the same page. Fade the model, switch teacher rotations, then revisit the visual sequence.

You Do

Use one fresh WH question about The Pumpkin Book: "What happened at the beginning, middle or end, and how do you know?" Grade 3: Use one page detail to explain what the book teaches. Grade 4: Compare two details and explain how they support the central idea. Record the page or illustration, response mode, prompt level and whether the student identified the story-structure element.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: The learner not with the teacher uses a previously taught three-picture sequence, WH picture sort, character/setting match or known Vizzle task from The Pumpkin Book. When finished, the learner may complete the week's book craft or quiet enrichment. The teacher then switches and teaches the other learner from the same scene.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Real books: The Pumpkin Book. Bring the props and response mats in the weekly book guide.

Book connection for this subject

The Pumpkin Book | Sort facts, illustrations and text features into a central idea with supporting details.

Writing TEKS 3.7B

Write a response to a literary or informational text that demonstrates an understanding of a text.

Writing TEKS 4.7B

Write responses that demonstrate understanding of texts, including comparing and contrasting ideas across a variety of sources.

Writing and spelling

After the shared read-aloud and comprehension sequence, each learner makes an individual response from the same book. Grade 3: Use one page detail to explain what the book teaches. Grade 4: Compare two details and explain how they support the central idea. Offer large primary writing lines, a picture-to-sentence frame, tracing, dictation or AAC. Record composition separately from oral or picture evidence.

Visual WH and story-structure routine

Use the same book for both learners. Show who, what, where, when, why and how picture cards. Ask about the beginning, middle and end. Arrange three scene cards, then let each learner answer with pointing, AAC, speech, dictation or writing. Record the response mode and prompt level.

Craft or enrichment after comprehension

Make a large-print pumpkin life-cycle accordion book with picture labels and one fact per panel.

8-9 AM read-aloud

The Pumpkin Book by Gail Gibbons. Return to the real pages for evidence; see the weekly book guide.

Math

2026-11-09 | Week 5 | Small actions help

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.3A, 3.3C

3.3A: Represent fractions greater than zero and less than or equal to one with denominators of 2, 3, 4, 6, and 8 using concrete objects and pictorial models, including strip diagrams and number lines. In plain English: Model fractions from greater than zero through one, using halves, thirds, fourths, sixths and eighths. 3.3C: Explain that the unit fraction 1/b represents the quantity formed by one part of a whole that has been partitioned into b equal parts where b is a non-zero whole number. In plain English: Explain that a unit fraction is one equal part of a whole. Today: Select 3 of the 4 equal parts and show three fourths.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.5B

4.5B: Represent problems using an input-output table and numerical expressions to generate a number pattern that follows a given rule representing the relationship of the values in the resulting sequence and their position in the sequence. In plain English: Use a rule, an input-output table and expressions to represent a number pattern. Today: Continue 2, 4, 6; then find output 7 for input 5 under add 2.

I Do

Book connection: Partition a pumpkin model into equal parts and build or name the week's fractions with picture pieces. Grade 3: Fold an equal-size paper whole into 4 equal parts; select one part and name one fourth. Grade 4: Build 2, 4, 6 counters. Say the rule is add 2. Use an input-output mat to show input 3 gives output 5 under add 2.

We Do

Return to The Pumpkin Book and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Both students handle the shared materials. Practice one example with the teacher; then teach the two targets in separate rotations.

You Do

Grade 3: Select 3 of the 4 equal parts and show three fourths. Grade 4: Continue 2, 4, 6; then find output 7 for input 5 under add 2.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Complete a mastered counting/sorting tray or known Bridges practice task at the student's established level.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Counters, plates/cups and the linked math mat. Select the matching grade-level STEMscopes lesson. Use Bridges placement to choose a separate foundational intervention. Add a visual or prop from The Pumpkin Book that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

The Pumpkin Book | Partition a pumpkin model into equal parts and build or name the week's fractions with picture pieces.

Science

2026-11-09 | Week 5 | Small actions help

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8A

3.8A: Identify everyday examples of energy, including light, sound, thermal, and mechanical. In plain English: Recognize everyday examples of light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. Today: Identify light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8A, 4.8B, 4.8C

4.8A: Investigate and identify the transfer of energy by objects in motion, waves in water, and sound. In plain English: Investigate how moving objects, water waves and sound transfer energy. 4.8B: Identify conductors and insulators of thermal and electrical energy. In plain English: Identify materials that let heat or electricity pass through and materials that resist it. 4.8C: Demonstrate and describe how electrical energy travels in a closed path that can produce light and thermal energy. In plain English: Show that electricity travels around a closed path and can produce light and heat. Today: Observe energy transfer, test materials and build a closed circuit.

I Do

Book connection: Observe and label pumpkin parts or growth stages, then connect each observation to the information page. Grade 3: Show a flashlight, shaker, safely lukewarm sealed bottle and moving car. Name light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. Grade 4: Use moving cars, sound, thermal conductors and a low-voltage battery circuit to observe transfer. Close the path to light a bulb; open it to stop.

We Do

Return to The Pumpkin Book and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Predict with objects or pictures, test together, then identify what changed. Keep one test variable different and other relevant conditions the same.

You Do

Grade 3: Match an object to its energy form; demonstrate one observable change. Grade 4: Show a transfer or closed circuit and identify what changed.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Sort familiar object/photo matches away from the experiment station. Experiments are adult supervised.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Fraction pieces, counters, puppets, flashlight, sealed lukewarm bottle, magnet, paper clips, felt, board. Adult manages circuit parts, magnets, small items and warm materials; use a low-voltage kit only. Add a visual or prop from The Pumpkin Book that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

The Pumpkin Book | Observe and label pumpkin parts or growth stages, then connect each observation to the information page.

Social studies

2026-11-09 | Week 5 | Small actions help

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.14A

3.14A: Gather information, including historical and current events and geographic data, about the community using a variety of resources. In plain English: Gather community information from different sources, including history, current events and geography. Today: Notice who made a historical source.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.3A

4.3A: Analyze the causes, major events, and effects of the Texas Revolution, including the Battle of the Alamo, the Texas Declaration of Independence, the Runaway Scrape, and the Battle of San Jacinto. In plain English: Explain causes, major events and effects of the Texas Revolution. Today: Identify a cause of the Texas Revolution.

I Do

Book connection: Compare two simple sources about pumpkins and name which detail each source contributes. Grade 3: Notice who made a historical source. Model with one district source, naming the visible clue. Grade 4: Identify a cause of the Texas Revolution. Use the current Texas history map, image or excerpt; name the person/event and point to the evidence.

We Do

Return to The Pumpkin Book and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Work together with a second example from the same source set. Teacher models looking for one visible clue at a time. Keep the grade-specific question visible and fade added hints.

You Do

Grade 3: Notice who made a historical source. Grade 4: Identify a cause of the Texas Revolution. Use a fresh source/card; accept a model, pointing, AAC or a spoken explanation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match two familiar source pictures or complete a known picture-to-object task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

District source pictures or excerpts, two-event sequence mat and writing/history frames. The classroom texts do not replace Texas history sources. Add a visual or prop from The Pumpkin Book that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

The Pumpkin Book | Compare two simple sources about pumpkins and name which detail each source contributes.